

HEALING FOR THE HOMES SERIES

MY SPOUSE BROKE ME, GOD— HOW DO I HEAL?

He heals the brokenhearted
and binds up their wounds.

— PSALM 147:3



Overcomers
Global Network
EDUCATE. EQUIP. EVOLVE

BY PROPHET JOSHUA MATTHEWS

DEDICATION

This booklet is dedicated to every husband and wife who has been shattered by the person who vowed to love them. You stood at an altar, spoke words of forever, and believed them — and then the very person you trusted with your heart became the one who crushed it. Your pain is valid. Your tears are seen. And God is about to enter your wound with healing only He can bring.

A MESSAGE FROM THE FOUNDER

Dear friend,

Ministry has taken me into the living rooms and prayer closets of marriages that are bleeding. I have held the hands of wives who trembled as they told me what their husbands had done. I have listened to husbands who wept because they could not reach their wives emotionally, spiritually, or any other way. Marriage wounds are some of the deepest I have ever encountered — because the closer the relationship, the deeper the cut.

I wrote this booklet for you — the one who is still in the marriage and hurting, the one who has already left, and the one who is trying to decide what to do next. I am not going to tell you what decision to make about your marriage. That is between you and God. But I am going to show you how to heal — regardless of what happens with your spouse. Because your healing is not dependent on their behavior. It is dependent on Christ.

With all my love in Christ,

Joshua Matthews

Founder, Overcomers Global Network

The Cry of the Soul

The person who was supposed to be your safe place became your most dangerous place. The one who vowed "for better or for worse" gave you the worst. And the cruelest part is that they had the key to the parts of you that no one else could reach — your vulnerabilities, your insecurities, your deepest needs — and they used those keys to lock you in a prison of pain.

Maybe it was infidelity — the discovery that they had given to someone else what belonged to your covenant. The images in your head. The questions that never stop: "When did it start? Was it my fault? Did they ever really love me?"

Maybe it was emotional abuse — the slow, systematic destruction of your confidence through criticism, contempt, control, and manipulation. You didn't even realize it was abuse at first because they told you it was love. "I only say these things because I care." "If you weren't so [fill in the blank], I wouldn't have to react this way." And over time, you started to believe them.

Maybe it was neglect — the cold shoulder that lasted months, the absence of affection, the feeling of being a roommate instead of a partner. They were physically present but emotionally gone, and you slowly starved in a house full of food.

Maybe it was verbal destruction — words spoken in anger that cannot be unheard, names that cannot be unnamed, insults that buried themselves in your identity like shrapnel.

Whatever the wound, the result is the same: the person you chose to build your life with became the person who tore it down. And you are left standing in the rubble, wondering how to heal from something this devastating.

What the Bible Says

God understands the pain of a covenant broken by the one who was supposed to honor it. He speaks of it with raw emotion through the prophet Malachi:

""Because the Lord has been witness between you and the wife of your youth, with whom you have dealt treacherously; yet she is your companion and your wife by covenant.""

— **Malachi 2:14 (NKJV)**

God calls it what it is: treachery. He does not soften it or excuse it. When a spouse breaks covenant, God sees it clearly and calls it by its name. Your pain is not an overreaction — it is a response to a real betrayal of a sacred bond.

But God also speaks as someone who has experienced this kind of pain. In Hosea, God instructed the prophet to marry a woman named Gomer who would repeatedly be unfaithful to him — as a living picture of how Israel had been unfaithful to God. Hosea experienced the heartbreak of loving someone who kept leaving, kept betraying, kept choosing others over the covenant.

And yet God said:

""I will heal their backsliding, I will love them freely, for My anger has turned away from him.""

— **Hosea 14:4 (NKJV)**

Even in the face of repeated betrayal, God chose to heal and love. This does not mean you must stay in a destructive situation — it means God's capacity for healing extends even to the most broken covenants.

Jesus also spoke words of deep comfort for those whose relationships have caused them suffering:

""Come to Me, all you who labor and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest. Take My yoke upon you and learn from Me, for I am gentle and lowly in heart, and you will find rest for your souls.""

— **Matthew 11:28–29 (NKJV)**

The Root of the Pain

Trauma Bonding. Many spouses in destructive marriages experience what psychologists call "trauma bonding" — a powerful emotional attachment that forms through cycles of abuse and affection. The abuser alternates between cruelty and kindness, creating a bond that feels like love but is actually manipulation. This is why it is so hard to leave — the bond is physiological, not just emotional. The brain becomes addicted to the cycle of pain and relief.

Understanding this does not make you weak — it makes you informed. And information is the first step toward freedom.

Identity Erosion. When a spouse systematically criticizes, controls, or belittles you, your sense of self erodes. You begin to see yourself through their distorted lens. Their words become your inner voice. You forget who you were before them — your strengths, your personality, your dreams, your laughter.

Rebuilding identity after spousal destruction is one of the most important aspects of healing. You are not who they said you are. You are who God says you are.

The Grief of a Living Loss. When a spouse wounds you, you grieve — but unlike the death of a loved one, the person you are grieving is still alive, still present, still capable of inflicting more pain. This creates a unique and agonizing form of grief. You are mourning the loss of the person you thought they were, the marriage you thought you had, and the future you thought you were building.

Effects on Children. If children are involved, the pain multiplies. Watching your children absorb the fallout of a broken marriage — the tension, the arguments, the divided household — adds a layer of guilt, helplessness, and protectiveness that can be overwhelming. But know this: your healing is the greatest gift you can give your children. When they see you walk through fire and emerge whole, they learn that God is faithful.

Christ's Healing Power

I want to speak something over you right now that the Holy Spirit is pressing on my heart: **Your spouse's sin does not define your worth.** Say that out loud. "My spouse's sin does not define my worth."

Whether they cheated, whether they were cruel, whether they abandoned you emotionally or physically — their choices are a reflection of *their* brokenness, not your value. You are not damaged goods because someone damaged you. You are a precious creation of God, and His opinion of you has not changed because of what was done to you.

""For I know the thoughts that I think toward you, says the Lord, thoughts of peace and not of evil, to give you a future and a hope.""

— Jeremiah 29:11 (NKJV)

God still has thoughts of peace toward you. He still has a future planned for you. What your spouse did may have altered the path, but it did not cancel the destination. God is a master at rerouting broken lives to glorious outcomes.

Healing from spousal wounds requires intentional steps:

1. Name the wound. Stop minimizing what happened. Call it what it was — whether that is infidelity, emotional abuse, neglect, or verbal destruction. Minimizing the wound keeps it from healing.

2. Process the grief. Allow yourself to grieve the marriage you lost — or the marriage you never truly had. This is not weakness. It is necessary.

3. Seek wise counsel. Find a trusted pastor, Christian counselor, or therapist. Do not walk through this alone. The enemy picks off isolated sheep.

4. Set boundaries. Whether you remain in the marriage or separate, boundaries are essential for your protection and healing. Boundaries are not walls — they are fences with gates. You decide who gets in and under what conditions.

5. Anchor your identity in Christ. Your identity is not "broken spouse." Your identity is "child of the Most High God." Read, meditate on, and declare the truths of who God says you are until they overwrite the lies your spouse spoke over you.

Healing Prayers

A Prayer for a Wounded Spouse

Father God, my spouse was supposed to be my partner, my protector, my best friend. Instead, they became the source of my deepest pain. Lord, I bring this wound to You — every harsh word, every betrayal, every night I cried myself to sleep. Heal me, Lord. Not just the surface — go deep. Touch the places where their words became my identity. Speak Your truth louder than their lies. Remind me that I am loved, valued, and worth dying for — because You proved it on the cross. In Jesus' name, amen.

A Prayer for Wisdom About the Marriage

Lord, I do not know what to do about this marriage. Some days I want to fight for it. Other days I want to run. I need Your wisdom — not human advice, not emotional reactions, but genuine divine direction. Show me what is right. Show me what is safe. Show me what honors You. Whether You are asking me to stay and contend, or giving me permission to go and be safe, make it clear. I trust Your guidance, not my confusion. Lead me, Shepherd. In Jesus' name, amen.

A Prayer for the Children

Father, my children are caught in the middle of something they did not create. Protect their hearts. Shield their minds. Do not let the brokenness of this marriage define their view of love, of marriage, or of You. Surround them with Your peace. Give me the grace to parent them through this storm with patience, love, and honesty. Let them see Your faithfulness even in our family's imperfection. Cover them, Lord. In Jesus' mighty name, amen.

Prophetic Declarations

"My spouse's sin does not define my worth. God's Word does."

"I am not damaged goods. I am a healed vessel in the hands of God."

"God has a future and a hope for me — regardless of what happened in my marriage."

"I will not be destroyed by what happened to me. I will be refined."

"My identity is rooted in Christ, not in my marriage."

"My children are covered by the hand of God."

"Healing is happening in me — day by day, layer by layer."

"I release the pain and I receive God's peace."

"God is rebuilding what was torn down — stronger and more beautiful."

"I will love again. I will trust again. But first, I will heal."

Reflection & Healing

Reflect on These Questions

1. What specifically did your spouse do that broke you? Name it without minimizing.
2. How has the wound affected the way you see yourself? What lies have you believed about your worth?
3. Have you been processing this pain with a trusted counselor or friend — or have you been carrying it alone?
4. What boundaries do you need to establish for your protection and healing?

5. What does God say about you that contradicts what your spouse said or did?

6. What does healing look like for you? Not necessarily the restoration of the marriage — but the restoration of *you*?

Beloved, the vow they broke was between them and God. But the love God has for you is unbreakable. He is mending what was shattered. Let Him work. You will come out of this whole.

A CLOSING PRAYER

Father, I bring before You a wounded spouse. You see the damage — the lies, the neglect, the cruelty, the betrayal, the emotional destruction. Lord, this is a deep wound, and it needs a deep healing.

I ask You, in the name of Jesus Christ, to touch the broken places in their heart. Where trust was destroyed, begin to rebuild it — first with You. Where identity was shattered, restore it. Where love was weaponized, bring genuine, healing love. Where walls have been erected, give them wisdom on which walls to keep and which to bring down.

I decree that this reader will not be defined by their spouse's sin. I decree healing, wholeness, and restoration of the soul. Whether the marriage is rebuilt or released, the reader will come out of this fire refined and not destroyed. In Jesus' name, amen.

AN INVITATION TO CHRIST

If you have never given your life to Jesus Christ, or if marital pain has driven you away from God, come back to the only One who will never break your heart. Pray: "Lord Jesus, I am wounded and I need a healer, not just a counselor. I believe You died for me and rose again. I give You my broken heart, my broken marriage, and my broken life. Be my Lord and Savior. Fill me with Your Holy Spirit. Hold me together when everything else is falling apart. In Jesus' name, amen."

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MY SPOUSE BROKE ME, GOD— HOW DO I HEAL?

A hurting spouse can cause wounds that go deep into your soul. This booklet offers biblical wisdom, comfort, and practical steps to help you heal, restore your heart, and find your identity in Christ again.

IN THIS BOOKLET, YOU WILL DISCOVER:

- ◆ The pain of betrayal and broken trust
- ◆ What the Bible says about healing
- ◆ How to forgive without excusing
- ◆ Rebuilding your self-worth in Christ
- ◆ Moving forward with God's strength

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and binds up their wounds." – Psalm 147:3*



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